YORKSHIRE WENSLEYDALE PGI



THE BASICS

MAKE:	Crumbly
SUB MAKE:	Curd from a single day
POST-MAKE:	Wrapped, Rolled or Processed
SUB POST-MAKE:	Natural (leaf wrapped, wood or cloth girdle)
TYPICAL AGE PROFILE:	Typically one to two months
APPROXIMATE WEIGHT(S):	5kg
GEOGRAPHICAL ORIGIN:	Yorkshire, UK
PROTECTED STATUS:	UK GI - Protected Geographical Indication (PGI) Must be made in the Wensleydale area.
SPECIES OF MILKING ANIMAL:	Cow
BREED OF COW:	Breed not specified
RAW/PASTEURISED MILK:	Examples of both depending on cheesemaker
VEGETARIAN/ANIMAL RENNET:	Examples of both depending on cheesemaker
COMMONLY ENCOUNTERED VARIATIONS:	Flavoured varieties with additions such as cranberries and apricots

THE STORY

'A nice bit of Wensleydale' has become a national catchphrase thanks to the exploits of Wallace & Gromit, but the cheese has a history that dates back much further. French Cistercian monks began making a sheep's milk cheese in the region in the 12th century in what is believed to have been an attempt to recreate Roquefort. The recipe passed to local farmers after dissolution of the monasteries and evolved into the crumbly cows' milk cheese of today. Yorkshire Wensleydale is made by scalding the curds to remove whey and, after draining, they are piled up and cut into blocks in the vat. The blocks are turned, cut finer and stirred. They are then salted by hand and milled (cut finer again) before moulding. The cheeses are pressed for up to two days and can be bandaged in cloth. They are matured for at least one week and up to 12 months.

THE CHARACTER

The texture is firm and flaky with a white to ivory interior. The flavour takes in dairy and citrus notes.

PERFECT PARTNERS:

IPAs can work well with this cheese – the bitterness stands up to the acidity. Light fruit reds also work well with the creaminess.

Copyright © Academy of Cheese. All rights Reserved.